replace it with a new Israeli Broadcasting Corporation, which branded itself "Kan", a Hebrew word for "here". It was meant to be everything IBA was not: modern, relevant, and digital-savvy. (Channel 1 often looks like a public-access station in a mid-sized American city; its studios could be a broadcasting museum.) Above all, it was to be immune from political pressure. Kan would be exempt from the oversight regulations that apply to most public corporations, a move which would limit the government's ability to appoint directors or influence editorial decisions.

Netanyahu approved the plan, but in mid-2016, months before Kan was scheduled to launch, he had a change of heart. In public, he argued that scrapping the new public broadcaster would increase competition in the Israeli media. In private, though, he offered a different reason for killing it: a fear that the new broadcaster, unlike its predecessor, would become a critical, liberal voice. "What if everyone in the corporation were people from Breaking the Silence?" he asked during one closed meeting with journalists.[15]

Regev put it even more bluntly during a cabinet meeting that summer. "What's the point of the corporation if we don't control it?" she asked. "What, we'll put up the money, and then they'll broadcast whatever they want?"[16] Some of her colleagues were incredulous. Gila Gamliel, a fellow minister from Likud, said publicly that Regev's remarks "bordered on fascism… we should keep in mind that we are a democratic state," she said.

On the other hand there was Channel 20, a station launched in 2014 to offer programming about Jewish culture and heritage. It soon positioned itself as an Israeli version of Fox News, complete with a fluttering flag graphic in the lower-left corner. The channel was fined several times for airing news content, which its charter did not allow, including coverage of the big right-wing rally just days before the 2015 election. Yet it continued to push an agenda: after President Reuven Rivlin appeared at a December conference that also hosted a left-wing NGO, it accused him of "crossing a red line" and "spitting in the faces" of Israeli soldiers.

The digital media, too, came under pressure. *Ha'aretz* reported in 2015 that editors at Walla, the country's most popular news site, had been instructed to post more positive coverage of the prime minister's wife, Sara. The government does not regulate websites, of course. But Walla is owned by Bezeq, Israel's largest phone company, which was then engaged in sensitive talks with the state about reforming its lucrative landline business.